



Joe Lazar
Director-HR
Analog Devices India

“It is important to insist on formal qualifications and certifications, because employers are competing with global talent, so you need to hire the best. This could be very specific more to a Product Design company than IT services company.

“You need both formal education and suitable skills to progress. Standard- or industry-specific tests checks for skills that are needed for specific employment where as college / university tests are needed to test academic skills.

“At Analog Devices, formal education and basic skills are equally important. Basic skill sets are the foundation on which every assignment is built. Formal education gives you the tools and techniques to perform your job better, and is also important for you to excel in your domain.

“In our case, good performance, skills and academic record all go hand in hand. In very rare instances, candidates with poor academic record have shown great performance.

“I foresee that in the years to come, it will still be important that demonstrations of skills will be equally important as academic achievements.”

VETERAN?



Sumeet Sabharwal
Managing Director
NaviSite Inc.

“Formal education still remains a strong criterion for getting through the application-screening stage. At NaviSite, we focus less on qualifications once the candidate has been through the conventional pre-screening process. The minimum requirement to pass the pre-screening process is graduation. The qualifications held by candidate represent two things—maturity and commitment by doing a degree course.

“Conducting standardised tests would help—depending upon who conducts them, how they are conducted, what degree or level of knowledge is expected, and whether it’s done by a trusted body. We’d be pleased if they’re conduct at a level that is something similar to the Common Aptitude Tests (CAT).

“We give 30 per cent weight to qualifications held and 70 per cent to basic skills like analytical capabilities and logical reasoning for programming. Competency has to be proven by going through the technical test exercises that precedes the aptitude and personality exercises.”



Shrikant Kulkarni
Sr. Vice President-HR
KPIT Cummins
Infosystems Ltd

“Formal education is necessary for anyone who aspires to enter the IT industry. At KPIT Cummins, formal qualifications are the basic criteria to enter in the primary round for recruitment, and also an important benchmarking tool for filtering the applicants.

We give 30 per cent weight to the formal degree held by the candidate, and the remaining 70 per cent to skills possessed. This 70 per cent is further classified for different aspects like communication skills, knowledge of domain and industry, aptitude, and so on.

“After passing the technical interview, aptitude and personality tests, candidates are graded on a scale of 1 to 5 on the basis of their overall performance and we look for those who are above average.

“For specific requirements, we give programs or assignments to check whether candidates can show us satisfactory results. Here too, above average performers are selected.

“All the skills acquired by a person during the academic period are tested on the job, and those who prove themselves go further. At the end of the day, however, it’s the performance of the individual that tells the real story.”

As told to Samir Makwana (samir_makwana@thinkdigit.com)